

Sabin Subedi

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PhD Candidate at University of Strathclyde
Department of Economics

I am an applied economist working on health insurance and health financing. My research combines quasi-experimental causal inference with welfare analysis, and my doctoral work rests on around 47 million administrative health insurance claims records, obtained under a data-sharing agreement I proposed and negotiated. I program in R, Stata and Python, am an Associate Fellow of the UK's Higher Education Academy (AFHEA), and expect to submit my thesis in September 2026.

Education

PhD Economics, University of Strathclyde Oct 2023 - Exp. Submission Sept 2026

- Awarded a Research Excellence Award (full PhD tuition and stipend) by the University of Strathclyde; supervised by Dr. Markus Gehrsitz and Prof. Stuart McIntyre.
- Dissertation examines Nepal's National Health Insurance Program using causal inference methods (difference-in-differences, regression discontinuity and instrumental variables) applied to a large-scale administrative dataset of approximately 47 million observations, extended to a welfare and value-for-money assessment of the public subsidy.
- Accredited Safe Researcher (SRT) and ONS Accredited Researcher, with experience accessing and analysing sensitive linked administrative datasets in secure environments.
- Approved researcher within the Scottish National Safe Haven through eDRIS, working on the ESRC-funded *Give Them Time?* project, which uses linked Scottish administrative records held in the safe haven.
- Postgraduate Certificate in Research Methodology in Business and Management. Modules include Research Methods, Research Philosophy, and Programme and Policy Evaluation in Economics.

MSc Applied Economics, University of Strathclyde Sept 2023

- Awarded Distinction. Highest mark for dissertation.
- Recipient of the SBS Masters Scholarship Award (£9,000).
- Relevant modules: Health Economics (including cost-effectiveness analysis, decision modelling and budget impact analysis), Economic Appraisal and Modelling, Programme and Policy Evaluation in Economics, Analysis of Economic Data, Topics in Public Economics.

BBA (Honours), Kathmandu University School of Management June 2020

- Graduated with Honours degree. Awarded distinction for dissertation.
- Relevant modules: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, Econometrics, Research Methods, and Calculus I and II.
- Recipient of the Kathmandu University 50% scholarship and the Golden Jubilee Scholarship Scheme by the Embassy of India (undergraduate grant).

Job Market Paper

Adverse Selection in (Un)Subsidised Health Insurance: Evidence from Nepal's Age-70 Threshold.

Methods: Regression Discontinuity Design. [Draft available at sabinsubedi.com]

Governments in low- and middle-income countries are increasingly pursuing universal health coverage by building contributory health insurance programs in which enrolment mandates are weakly enforced and are therefore voluntary in practice. When enrolment is a choice, the premium determines both who enters the risk pool and the cost of insuring that pool. This paper presents the first quasi-experimental estimate of adverse selection in a national health insurance scheme in a low- or middle-income country. I exploit a statutory premium waiver at age 70 in Nepal's National Health Insurance Programme. Using the universe of enrolment and claims records, I implement a regression discontinuity design based on age at enrolment. Coverage nearly doubles at the threshold, increasing from 22 to 42 percent of the eligible population, and expands into areas that are poorer and farther from care. Claims per enrollee fall across every margin. Because enrolment itself responds to price, the discontinuity compares insurance pools with different compositions rather than a fixed population's healthcare use. The marginal enrollees induced by the zero price generate NPR 3,358 in claims per enrollee, compared with NPR 5,269 among those already paying, yielding a ratio of 0.637. The paid pool is therefore adversely selected, despite household bundling and restricted enrolment windows.

Working Papers

1. **Health Insurance and Health-Seeking Behaviour: The Distributional Effects of Public Health Insurance in Nepal.** Methods: Staggered Difference-in-Differences (Callaway and Sant'Anna). Eligibility raises health-facility visits by 14%, with similar gains across outpatient, emergency and diagnostic margins. Utilisation rises only in low-poverty districts; high-poverty districts show no significant effect. A 2019 facility-reassignment reform points to a supply-side explanation: the empanelled-facility network is too sparse in poor districts. University of Strathclyde working paper. [Draft available at sabinsubedi.com]
2. **Effect of Remittances on Farm Productivity after a Large Natural Disaster** (with Prakash Pathak and Agnese Romiti). Methods: Triple-Difference Instrumental Variables. Higher remittance inflows in high-intensity earthquake areas reduced household production in the short run, while consumption fell by an order of magnitude less. Households adjust through lower capital inputs and lower agricultural labour.
3. **Spending Beyond Its Means: The Fiscal Sustainability of Nepal's National Health Insurance Program** (with Mukesh Adhikari, Prashant Bhandari and Suresh Singh Tinkari). *Under review at Health Policy and Planning.* First author.

Research and Professional Experience

Teaching Fellow, Health Progress Hub - Global Health Fellowship Nov 2024 - Present

- Designed a curriculum from scratch and deliver training on quantitative methods and evidence-based policymaking for early-career researchers and health practitioners without an economics background, in low- and middle-income country settings.

Research Associate Placement, Fraser of Allander Institute Dec 2022 - March 2023

- Contributed to the construction of a Social Accounting Matrix for Scotland, and to policy-facing reports and briefings for government and non-academic stakeholders, developing skills in communicating quantitative findings to non-specialist audiences.

Statistical Consultant, Beth Israel Deaconess Medical Center May 2021 - August 2021

- Performed statistical analysis of clinical data at a Harvard Medical School teaching hospital, working with clinicians on a study of procedural skill acquisition in central venous catheter placement.

Presentations

European Conference in Health Economics (EuHEA)	Jul 2026
Health Economists' Study Group (HESG) Summer Programme	Jun 2026
Global Health Seminar Series, Centre for Health Economics, University of York	Apr 2026
Strathclyde PGR Conference	Mar 2024, 2025, 2026
Health Economists' Study Group (HESG) Winter Programme	Jan 2026
ECESS, Heriot-Watt University	Jan 2026
Scottish Graduate Programme in Economics (SGPE) Conference	Jan 2026
Economics PhD Reading Group, University of Glasgow	Dec 2024

Awards, Memberships and Accreditations

Associate Fellow of the Higher Education Academy (AFHEA)	2026
ONS Accredited Researcher (Provisional), AR number 51063	2026
Safe Researcher Training (SRT) Accreditation, renewed	2026
eDRIS Approved Researcher	Since 2023
Health Economists' Study Group Conference Scholarship	2025
Member of Health Economists' Study Group	Since 2024
Member of Royal Economic Society	Since 2024
Member of Scottish Economic Society	Since 2024
University of Strathclyde - Teaching Excellence Award (Shortlisted)	2023
University of Strathclyde - Research Excellence Award (Full PhD Tuition and Stipend)	2023
University of Strathclyde - SBS Masters Scholarship Award (£9,000)	2022
Golden Jubilee Scholarship Scheme, Embassy of India, Nepal	2016
Kathmandu University - 50% Undergraduate Scholarship	2016

Teaching

EC315: Topics in Microeconomics with Cross Section Econometrics (UG)

S2023 and S2024 at the University of Strathclyde

EC316: Topics in Macroeconomics with Time Series Econometrics (UG)

F2024, F2025 and F2026 at the University of Strathclyde

ECNM 11089: Econometrics 2 - Time Series (PG)

F2025 and F2026 at the University of Edinburgh

EC951: Analysis of Economic Data (PG)

F2024 and F2025 at the University of Strathclyde

Academic Service

Organiser, Postgraduate Mock Conference, Department of Economics, University of Strathclyde
Organiser, Brownbag Seminar Series, Department of Economics, University of Strathclyde
Student Representative, Department of Economics, University of Strathclyde

Training

Introduction to Machine Learning for Causal Inference, HESG 2026	2026
Machine Learning and Heterogeneous Treatment Effects, Mixtape Sessions	2025
Machine Learning and Causal Inference, Mixtape Sessions	2025
Causal Inference I, II, III and Design-Based Inference, Mixtape Sessions	2024
3rd SGPE PhD Summer School, University of Stirling	2024
MicroMasters in Data, Economics and Design of Policy (five courses, proctored exams), MITx 2022	

Research Interests

Applied Microeconometrics and Causal Inference.
Health Economics, Health Insurance and Health Financing.
Development Economics.
Public Economics and Welfare Analysis.
Economics of Migration and Remittances.

Languages and Software

Languages: Nepali (Native), English (Fluent), Hindi (Fluent)
Software: R (including R-Shiny, data.table and fixest), Stata, Python, LaTeX, Git, Tableau, SPSS, MS Office

References are available upon request.